

Clean Water and Hygiene

Clean hands, safe water and a clean village stop many sicknesses, especially diarrhoea in children.

For community members

Key messages

- Wash your hands with soap and water after using the toilet or cleaning a child, before cooking, before feeding children, before eating, and before breastfeeding.
- Water that looks clear is not always safe. Boil drinking water, let it cool, and keep it covered.
- Use a toilet. If you have none, bury stools. Keep animals away from small children.
- Dig a deep pit for rubbish, or bury or burn it. Rubbish attracts flies that spread germs.

- Wash plates and cups, and keep them covered from flies. A tippy tap is an easy way to wash hands with running water.
- Never use a baby bottle. Use a clean cup and spoon.

Take a child to the health centre if they have

- Diarrhoea with blood
- Diarrhoea for 14 days or more
- Very thirsty, dry lips and mouth, or passing very little urine
- Not able to drink or breastfeed, or vomiting everything

General information only. Follow the advice of your health centre and current national guidelines. Based on the National Department of Health Village Health Assistant (VHA) training curriculum.